

Color Psychology Guide

How to choose brand colours that set the right expectation, and how to apply them so your brand looks like one brand everywhere. With 12 ready-to-use palettes and their HEX codes.

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Colour sets the expectation. Consistency keeps the promise.

Colour psychology is not magic: a blue logo won't make a business trustworthy, and red won't force anyone to buy. What colour does is set an **expectation** before anyone reads a word. Trust is built when the experience matches that expectation, and when the same colours appear the same way on every post, package and sign.

When a brand feels "off", the problem is rarely the colour choice. It is usually that there are eleven slightly different versions of it.

What colours tend to signal

Colour	Tends to read as	Good for	Watch out
● Blue	Calm, competent, reliable	Finance, health, tech, NGOs	Very common: hard to stand out
● Green	Growth, nature, balance	Food, wellness, education	Strong religious and national meanings in the region
● Red	Energy, urgency, appetite	Food, sport, sales, events	Can feel aggressive; it is also Tunisia's flag colour
● Orange	Warm, friendly, affordable	Youth, food, community	Can look cheap if overused
● Yellow	Optimism, attention	Highlights, kids, campaigns	Poor contrast on white
● Purple	Creative, premium, unusual	Beauty, tech, creative studios	Can feel unrelated to food
● Black	Premium, serious, modern	Fashion, luxury, studios	Can feel cold without a warm accent
● Brown / earth	Authentic, handmade, grounded	Coffee, craft, artisan products	Can look dated without contrast

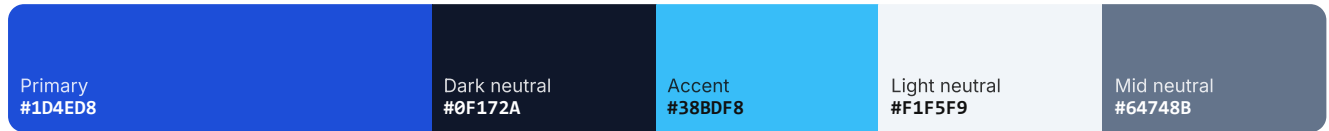
Cultural context matters. Brands working across Arabic, French and English audiences should test colours with real customers. In Tunisia, red and white evoke the flag, green carries religious weight, and gold and blue are strongly tied to tradition and the coast. These can be strengths, if they are chosen on purpose.

12 ready-to-use palettes

Starting points, not rules: adjust them to your positioning and test contrast. The first swatch is the primary colour.

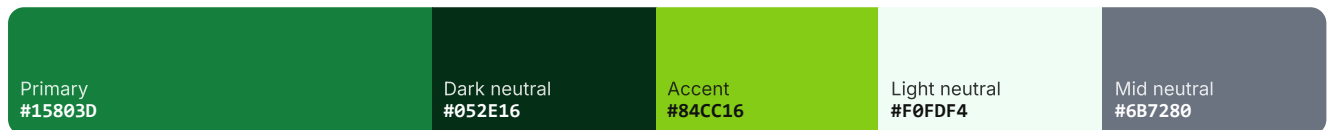
01 · Trust & clarity

Finance, consulting, health services, NGOs



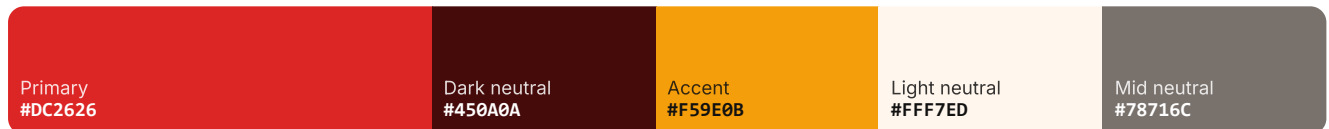
02 · Growth & health

Agriculture, wellness, education, sustainability



03 · Energy & appetite

Fast food, events, sports, promotions



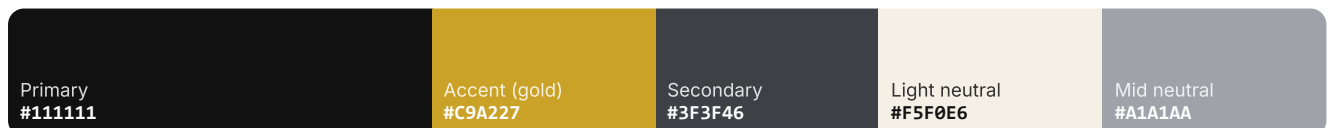
04 · Calm & care

Clinics, therapy, childcare, beauty



05 · Luxury & premium

Jewellery, real estate, studios, fashion



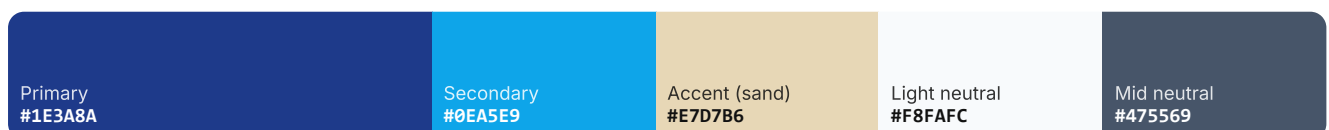
06 · Warm hospitality

Cafés, bakeries, restaurants, guest houses



07 · Mediterranean coast

Travel, tourism, seafood, coastal brands



08 · Fresh produce

Dates, olive oil, organic food, markets

Primary
#4D7C0F

Accent
#F97316

Secondary
#FEF3C7

Light neutral
#FAFAF9

Dark neutral
#44403C

09 · Tech & product

Startups, SaaS, apps, digital agencies

Primary
#6D28D9

Dark neutral
#0B0B12

Accent
#22D3EE

Light neutral
#F5F3FF

Mid neutral
#71717A

10 · Youthful & bold

Youth NGOs, campaigns, festivals, clubs

Primary
#DB2777

Dark neutral
#1E1B4B

Accent
#FACC15

Light neutral
#FDF2F8

Mid neutral
#6B7280

11 · Earthy craft

Artisans, ceramics, textiles, handmade

Primary
#92400E

Accent
#4D7C0F

Secondary
#F5E6D3

Light neutral
#FAF7F2

Mid neutral
#57534E

12 · Editorial & serious

Consultancies, research, think tanks, law

Primary
#0A0A0A

Accent
#16A34A

Secondary
#E7E5E4

Light neutral
#F5F5F4

Mid neutral
#737373

Give every colour a role

A brand needs roles, not a rainbow. When everything is a "brand colour", nothing guides the eye, and the most important button gets lost.

60% neutrals: backgrounds, text

30% primary

10%

A common starting split: about 60% neutrals, 30% primary, 10% accent. The accent is reserved for what you want clicked or noticed.

Role	Used for	Your HEX
Primary	Logo, key brand moments	
Neutrals	Most surfaces and all body text	
Accent	Calls to action, highlights only	
Status (optional)	Success, warning, error in apps and forms	

Check contrast before you ship

- ☐ Body text: contrast ratio of at least **4.5 : 1** against its background (WCAG AA)
- ☐ Large text and icons: at least **3 : 1**
- ☐ Never put text on yellow, light green or light orange without checking
- ☐ Check your palette in greyscale: if two colours become the same grey, don't rely on colour alone

Lock it in

- ☐ One exact HEX per colour (no "roughly this green")
- ☐ RGB for screens, CMYK and Pantone references for print
- ☐ The same values in Canva, Figma, your website and your printer's file
- ☐ A one-page sheet anyone on the team can find

Want help choosing and applying your palette? **Book a free 30-min call**

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